

UNCONVENTIONAL WISDOM

Week 1 Preview

■ WEEK 1 BOOK

Only the Paranoid Survive

by Andy Grove

256 pages • ~6 hours audio • Strategic Inflection Points

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Andy Grove survived the Holocaust as a child in Hungary. He escaped Communist rule at age 20 with nothing. He went on to co-found Intel and transform it from a memory chip company into the world's dominant microprocessor manufacturer — a \$200 billion empire.

Along the way, he navigated six near-death business crises. This book captures the hard-won wisdom from those battles.

THE BIG IDEA

Every business — every career — faces moments when the fundamental rules of the game change. Grove calls these **Strategic Inflection Points**. Most leaders see them too late. The paranoid see them coming.

"Business success contains the seeds of its own destruction. Success breeds complacency. Complacency breeds failure. Only the paranoid survive."

— Andy Grove

KEY CONCEPTS YOU'LL LEARN

- **The 10X Force:** When one of the six competitive forces changes by a factor of 10, everything shifts. Learn to spot these before your competitors do.
- **The Signal vs. Noise Problem:** How to distinguish between temporary disruptions and fundamental change — the difference between overreacting and being prepared.
- **Strategic Dissonance:** When your actions and your strategy diverge, you're in trouble. Grove's framework for diagnosing this before it's fatal.
- **The Valley of Death:** The terrifying period between your old strategy and your new one. How Intel survived it — and how you can too.
- **Cassandras:** The front-line people who see change coming before leadership does. Why you need to find them and listen to them.

ASSIGNMENT PREVIEW

In the full program, Week 1 includes a **Strategic Inflection Point Audit** where you'll:

- Map the 6 competitive forces in your industry
- Rate each force for likelihood of 10X change
- Identify your company's (or career's) Cassandras
- Complete the 'Fire Yourself' thought exercise
- Build your early warning detection system



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